

Ἰλιάς μικρά

Little Iliad Fragments and the Epic Cycle

eul_aid: afa

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)
Domain: Ἔπος [Epic](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

The Little Iliad is a lost epic poem from ancient Greece, composed around the 7th century BCE. It was part of the Epic Cycle, a collection of poems that together narrated the entire story of the Trojan War. The poem is anonymous; while later ancient sources proposed various authors, modern scholars consider these attributions unreliable.

The work does not survive intact. Our knowledge of it derives from fragments and a detailed prose summary written by the later scholar Proclus. According to this summary, the Little Iliad was four books long. It narrated events beginning with the contest for the armor of the dead hero Achilles, which led to the suicide of Ajax, and continued through the fall of Troy by means of the wooden horse and its immediate aftermath.

The poem's historical importance is significant. It provided the main narrative bridge between other epics in the Cycle, creating a continuous story of the war. Although the original text is lost, its plot was immensely influential. It established the canonical versions of many myths that were later adapted by major Greek playwrights like Sophocles and Euripides, and by Roman poets including Virgil in the Aeneid. The existence of the Little Iliad illustrates that Homer's famous poems were part of a much larger and thriving tradition of epic storytelling in archaic Greece.

Works (1)

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